

Chapter 81-1

Liang Shi remembered that previously at the entrance of the concert hall, when Zhao Ling was dumped by his girlfriend, his girlfriend had said she had fallen for Shen Siyan.

Anyone hearing this name would think it was a girl.

But... it was a guy?

Liang Shi and Zhao Xuning's astonishment was noticed by Zhao Ling, and he was also confused. "So you didn't know before?"

Zhao Xuning shook her head, her gaze still fixed on that direction. "No."

Shen Hui and Shen Siyan had already walked far away. She could only watch their retreating figures from afar.

Liang Shi also looked over. The siblings both had figures like clothes hangers.¹ The older sister was considered tall among Omegas, and the younger brother was a head taller than his sister, with good fashion sense too.

Standing together, the handsome man and beautiful woman made for quite an eye-catching sight.

Liang Shi patted Zhao Xuning's shoulder to offer comfort.

But Zhao Xuning turned around, her gaze icy cold, like shards of ice in the depths of winter. "Remove it."

Liang Shi: "?"

How ungrateful.

She withdrew her hand and stuffed it into her coat pocket, continuing to chat with Zhao Ling. "Which characters are used for the 'Si' and 'Yan' in his name? Is it the 'Yan' as in rock?"

Zhao Ling was still looking down at the photos from earlier, quite satisfied. He answered Liang Shi with a smile: "No, it's the 'Yan' with the female radical."²

"That name is so delicate." Liang Shi said, "Quite unique."

"It's not strange on him." Zhao Ling had a very poor relationship with him. After entering university, almost every girl he liked had run off to like Shen Siyan instead.

Good at studying, high looks, skilled at horseback riding, and also good at gaming.

Most importantly: a lone wolf.

This trait attracted many Omegas and Betas. Any pretty one would want to try their luck with him, but basically all of them returned in defeat.

Legends about him still circulated in the grade group chat.

Right after enrollment, he made a pretty senior girl—famous for "slaying Alphas"—fail miserably, losing fifty thousand yuan.

Because their bet was fifty thousand yuan.

After this incident came to light, someone who had drunk too much teased Shen Siyan about it at a party, asking what his thoughts were.

Shen Siyan had just two words: "Boring."

Everyone thought he was the most boring one, but Omegas just loved his type.

The grudge between Zhao Ling and him was absolutely irreconcilable.

After hearing this, Liang Shi's eyelid twitched. She thought to herself, how big of a grudge could a bunch of kids have? But then Zhao Ling said expressionlessly: "The grudge of stealing my wife."

Liang Shi: "..."

She suddenly remembered what happened that day at the concert hall entrance.

That was truly an undeserved disaster for Shen Siyan.

Zhao Ling invited them to eat outside the school.

Because Zhao Xuning didn't really like the atmosphere of group meals, Zhao Ling had the junior students go find their own place to eat, leaving just the three of them.

On the way to eat, Zhao Ling started chatting. "Shen Siyan is really strange. He's a total sister-complex, plus a tattletale, and everything he does is so effeminate. It's hard to believe he's an Alpha."

Zhao Xuning glanced at him sideways. "And that's a reason for you to hit someone?"

"Didn't he end up hitting me in the end?" Zhao Ling showed her his wrist. "There's still a wound here."

Zhao Xuning: "The one who provokes first..."

"Ning-jie!"³ Zhao Ling was so anxious his eyes went wide. "What are you saying? Who's actually your younger cousin here?"

"I side with reason, not with family." Zhao Xuning said.

Zhao Ling: "..."

He gritted his teeth in anger. "I think you're just siding with that older sister, what's her name... Shen Hui, right?"

Zhao Xuning: "None of your business."

Zhao Ling was so angry at Zhao Xuning that he was about to explode. Liang Shi remarked from the side, "Has she been bullying you like this since you were kids?"

Zhao Ling immediately looked aggrieved and found someone to complain to. "Yeah! Sister Liang, let me tell you, my cousin is just a..."

"Smack."

Zhao Xuning slapped Zhao Ling on the shoulder. "Will you die if you don't talk?"

Zhao Ling: "..."

"You see that, right?" Zhao Ling immediately distanced himself far from Zhao Xuning. "She's a violent maniac."

"This is called fighting violence with violence." Zhao Xuning said.

Zhao Ling made a face at her.

The atmosphere between the two was actually quite affectionate. For Liang Shi, who had never experienced sibling bonds, it was quite novel.

Although after coming to this world, Liang Xinzhou and Liang Xinhe had let her experience a little of it.

But both of them were older and had their own families. The care they showed her was mainly in terms of living necessities and finances. She had always been reserved and wouldn't have this kind of relaxed chatting atmosphere with them.

This kind of interaction was a bit like children.

Playfully fighting, but never holding grudges. Even if they argued, they would make up soon after.

It was quite enviable.

"Have you two been like this since you were kids?" Liang Shi asked.

Zhao Ling nodded. "Yes, I've been their punching bag—hers and my older sister's."

Liang Shi chuckled softly. "Poor you."

Zhao Ling nodded repeatedly. "Both my older sisters are fierce and heartless."

"I'll call your older sister." Zhao Xuning said.

Zhao Ling immediately backed down. "Don't, Ning-jie, I was wrong."

Zhao Xuning glanced at him sideways but said nothing.

Zhao Ling followed beside Liang Shi, looking like a fawning lackey, and couldn't help but sigh. "In comparison, Sister Liang, you're a fairy—the kind that doesn't belong to the mortal world."⁴

Liang Shi was amused by him and teased, "Even if you flatter me like this, I'm still not paying the bill later."

"I'll pay." Zhao Ling said, "You've helped me so much. How could I possibly let you pay?"

Zhao Ling complained to her about Shen Siyan, that nitpicky cold weirdo, and also mentioned his name.

"He seems to have three older sisters." Zhao Ling said, "But the third sister died shortly after birth."

"So he inherited his sister's name?" Liang Shi was surprised.

"No." Zhao Ling said, "Think about it—'Siyan,' it means 'missing Yan,' his third sister, right? That's why I said he's definitely a sister-complex."

Zhao Xuning said coldly from the side: "Still better than you being unfilial."

Zhao Ling: "...???"

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1. "Clothes hangers" (衣服架子) — A Chinese expression meaning someone with a figure that makes any clothes look good on them, like a mannequin or clothes hanger. ↩
 2. The character "妍" (yán) — meaning beautiful or elegant, contains the female/woman radical (女). This character is typically used in feminine names, which is why it's surprising for a male to have it in his name. ↩
 3. "Ning-jie" — "Jie" (姐) means "older sister." Zhao Ling is calling Zhao Xuning by a shortened, affectionate version of her name plus the honorific for older sister, showing their familial relationship. ↩
 4. "Doesn't belong to the mortal world" (不食人間煙火) — Literally "doesn't eat the smoke and fire of the mortal world," a Chinese idiom describing someone who seems ethereal, otherworldly, or too pure and elegant to be part of ordinary human life. ↩